PAID MEDIA PLAN · 25 AUGUST 2026

ROO on Meta

Three creatives, $700 over four weeks, how we pick the winner, and when each piece lands.

Veejay Atienza **Five slides,** then appendices for the detail behind them

1 THE CREATIVES

Three, one per format

CONCEPT	FORMAT	WHAT IT SHOWS	WHY IT EARNS A SLOT
The Dump	Video + VO `15s, 9:16`	Chopping into the pouch, then the pouch lifted and emptied	The only concept that shows what happens to the mess. Motion is the only way to show it, and nothing else we own tells that story.
Counter Comparison	Static, two-up	Mat with vegetables against a bare counter covered in scraps	Comprehension in one frame, no sound and no autoplay needed. Cheapest to make, and the control the video has to beat.
Family Narrator	Photo carousel `5 cards, text on screen`	“My dad ran a restaurant kitchen for 20 years…” ending on the mat	The one format with proven pull on this account. Needs no new footage and no voice.

Why three and not six. Meta suppresses ads inside an ad set that are more than about 60% similar, so extra variations of one idea behave like one ad. Three genuinely different formats is also the most we can fund at roughly **$8 a day each** and still read a result.

The footage constraint. We have stills of the mat and the mat with vegetables, and video of chopping on the mat and board with a person in frame. We have nothing of anyone talking about the product. So everything is voiced over or captioned, and nothing depends on a talking head we cannot shoot.

All three land on the mat page at $44.99, not the bundle. Appendix A.

2 BUDGET AND DURATION

$25 a day for four weeks, inside a range

LEVEL	DAILY	4 WEEKS	DAYS FOR A CREATIVE TO BECOME READABLE	WHAT IT BUYS
Too thin	$10	$280	6.0	Half the flight is spent just reaching a judgeable impression count.
Floor	$15	$420	4.0	Screens three creatives and nothing more. No room to replace a loser and still judge the replacement.
Recommended	$25	$700	**2.4**	Kill a loser in week one, put a replacement in, and it still clears the bar before the decision. A four or five creative test in the same window.
Top of guardrail	$30	$840	2.0	As above with a second iteration cycle inside the four weeks. $900 a month, the ceiling with gifting paused.
A true intent test	$50–75	$1,400–2,100	<1.2	The only level that ranks creatives on add-to-cart. Breaks the guardrail and cannot be justified at $8 contribution.

The honest limit at any of these. $15 gives about 7 add-to-carts per creative over four weeks and $25 gives 11. Neither ranks creatives on intent. **No budget ROO can afford does.** So this test answers the attention question, and we should say so rather than pretend otherwise.

Why $25 beats $15 mechanically. Inside one ad set Meta concentrates spend on an early favourite and starves the rest. At $15 that collapses a three-way test into a one-creative test within days. At $25 the other two still carry enough absolute spend to stay readable while Meta plays favourites.

I cut the wrong variable last time. The right saving was six weeks down to four, not $25 a day down to $15. Duration was the waste. Daily rate is what makes the test work.

3 THE PROJECTION

Every scenario loses money on the first order

WHAT THE MAT PAGE LOOKS LIKE WHEN TRAFFIC LANDS	SITE CVR	ORDERS	REVENUE	CAC	NET COST OF THE TEST
Left exactly as it is today	0.67%	4	$192	**$164**	$666
Three page bugs fixed first	1.5%	10	$430	**$73**	$624
Page bugs fixed and checkout improved	2.5%	16	$716	**$44**	$573

The three page bugs, since they set the difference between row one and row two. The mat page currently lists the cutting board's contents and describes itself as rubberwood, a section renders twice on it, and the homepage still says "restocking soon" above three products that are all in stock. **Row three additionally assumes** the checkout drop-off in Appendix B gets diagnosed and reduced, which is a bigger job and not promised here.

Break-even CAC is about **$8**, so even the best row loses roughly $36 an order. At that margin no cold paid channel in the US pays for itself, which is a margin fact rather than a Meta one. Appendix A.

The middle row is what I expect. The last column barely moves, so **the test costs about $620 whatever happens**. At the $15 floor that figure is about $370, for a materially weaker read.

We are buying two answers, not customers. Who the earliest adopters are, and which proposition converts them. Both then feed search, organic, email, and affiliates, where there is no cost per order.

4 TESTING, AND PROCEEDING WITH A WINNER

Screen for two weeks, confirm for two, then iterate flat

Weeks 1–2
Screen

All three live in one ad set on equal footing. Judge on **link CTR and cost per landing page view**, because there will not be enough purchases to judge on purchases. Anything under **0.5% CTR after 1,000 impressions** comes out and is replaced.

Weeks 3–4
Confirm

Now judge on **cost per add-to-cart**. A creative leading on CTR but not on add-to-cart is winning attention and losing intent, and add-to-cart wins that argument. The leader has to hold for **a full week** before we call it. One good day is noise.

Then
Proceed

Do **not** scale by raising the winner's budget. At this level there is no headroom, and a budget edit resets the learning phase. Instead build **two new executions of the winning angle** and retire the two losers. Spend stays flat and the angle compounds.

One variable at a time, as agreed. Creative is the only thing that moves. Audience stays broad, price stays fixed, landing page stays fixed. If more than one thing changes we cannot attribute the result.

Budget only rises once the angle is confirmed *and* the financial model says paid can work, and then by 10 to 20% every three or four days rather than in jumps.

Continue if one creative is clearly ahead, cost per add-to-cart is under $16, and a demographic pattern is readable.

Stop if $250 goes by with zero add-to-carts, or four weeks end with nothing separating.

5 TIMELINE

Build for a week, run for four, decide on 28 September

WEEK	DATES	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER
17	Aug 25–31	Three site fixes. Tracking checks in Events Manager. Shoot footage culled and the three creatives cut. Financial model started.	Veejay `model: Steve`
18	Sep 1–7	Campaign built and launched mid-week, so the first weekend runs on a settled ad set.	Veejay
18–19	Sep 1–14	**Screen.** All three on equal footing. Judge link CTR and cost per landing page view. Replace anything under 0.5% CTR.	Veejay
20–21	Sep 15–28	**Confirm.** Judge cost per add-to-cart. The leader has to hold for a full week before we call it.	Veejay
21	Sep 28	**Decision.** Continue, extend once, or stop. The financial model should be in hand, and the two together decide whether paid gets another cent.	Both
22+	Sep 29 on	If continuing: two new executions of the winning angle replace the two losers, spend flat at $25.	Veejay

Weekly review at each existing call, with a continue, shift, or stop read each time rather than one verdict at the end. **Nothing here blocks creative production**, so week 17 runs regardless of what is decided on the budget.

Four weeks of spend is the shortest window that produces a readable answer, and the longest the current margin justifies before the financial model exists.

APPENDICES

The detail behind it

Unit economics, the conversion ceiling, campaign build, what we learned on TikTok, and the open items.

A Unit economics B The conversion ceiling C Campaign build D TikTok read-across E Open items

APPENDIX A UNIT ECONOMICS

Break-even is $8, and the mat is the whole business

Boards cost **$6 to $7**, bought outside volume, then branded, packed, and shipped in house. The board sells at $20 alone or adds $10 to the mat, and its margin is **“basically nothing”**.

So the bundle adds ten dollars of price for roughly ten dollars of board, packaging, and extra shipping weight. **It raises order value without raising what we keep**, which is why paid traffic goes to the mat.

This is a reconstruction from the call, not a confirmed P&L. The mini financial model is what verifies it, and it decides whether paid is ever viable here.

PRODUCT	PRICE	CONTRIBUTION	BREAK-EVEN CAC
Board	$19.99	~$2.50	**$2.50**
Bundle	$54.99	~$8 or less	**$8.00**
Mat	$44.99	~$8.00	$8.00

No offer lever exists. Shipping is already free, so it cannot be added. A 10% discount on the mat is $4.50, which is 56% of contribution. 15% is 84%. The variable we can move is the message, not the price.

No repeat cushion. 33 buyers have placed 36 orders, so lifetime value is about 1.09 orders. There is no second purchase to earn the first one back.

APPENDIX B THE CONVERSION CEILING

The site sets the CAC before the ads do

Between 2 and 14 August the store did 149 sessions, 8 add-to-carts, 8 checkouts started, and **1 completed order**. Cold US traffic at $1.10 a visit runs through that as follows.

Sample caveat: n = 8. The true completion rate sits between 2.2% and 47.1% at 95% confidence, so this directs where we look rather than settling it. Bot traffic is the first thing to rule out, and 8 of 8 carts reaching checkout is not a normal human funnel shape.

SITE CONVERSION RATE	IMPLIED CAC AT $1.10 / VISIT
0.67% (today)	**$164**
1.0%	$110
1.5%	$73
2.0%	$55
2.5%	$44
3.0%	$37

Shipping is free, confirmed against the live rates API: Standard, $0.00, three to four days. Shop Pay is enabled. So neither a cost surprise nor express-checkout friction explains the drop-off, which leaves bot traffic, the guarantee doing no work at the moment of decision, and price resistance.

On abandoned cart recovery: worth switching on, it is free, but at roughly 16 abandoned checkouts a month it recovers about one order. Hygiene, not a growth lever.

APPENDIX C CAMPAIGN BUILD

One campaign, one ad set, broad

```
META_Sales_Broad-US_Mat_2026W18
└── Ad Set: Broad US · Advantage+ Audience · Purchase optimisation
    │   destination: /products/roo · the mat at $44.99
    ├── Ad 1  The Dump              video + VO
    ├── Ad 2  Counter Comparison    static, two-up
    └── Ad 3  Family Narrator       photo carousel, text on screen
```

Why one ad set. Meta wants a daily budget near five times target CPA and about 50 conversions a week to leave the learning phase. We will be at neither. Splitting the money just buys three underpowered ad sets instead of one, so creative stays the only variable.

Broad targeting, as agreed: no interest stacking, let the algorithm find it, narrow only once a demographic pattern shows. Exclusions from day one are past purchasers, site visitors in the last 14 days, and the customer email list.

Tracking is already in place. Pixel 427068866582509 runs through Shopify's Meta app on the maximum data-sharing tier, so the Conversions API is live server-side too. Three checks before launch: Purchase carries value and currency, match quality at or above 8.5, domain verified.

No lookalike. A usable seed needs 1,000 people and we have 33 buyers. It comes back around month three, not now.

Retargeting is not in this plan. Four weeks at $25 a day produces about 636 visitors, which never reaches deliverable size, and at $8 contribution it would not pay for itself if it did.

APPENDIX D TIKTOK READ-ACROSS

One thing carries over. One thing does not.

Carries over: the family narrator wins. Same week, same account, same slide structure. The butcher and fire marshal posts did 730 and 448 views. The rebuilt dad's knives carousel did 3,923 and 5,425, with the strongest engagement day in the entire 60-day file.

Does not carry over: where the product sits. On TikTok the format works because the mention lands on the second-to-last slide as a credit. That is what makes it feel native. In a paid ad we are buying the impression, so that structure is backwards.

That is now true twice, with a controlled comparison in the same week, so it is a rule rather than a hunch. It is why concept 3 exists.

The July TikTok Shop ads are the proof: **$75 spent, 427 impressions, 2 clicks, 0.47% CTR**, and retention collapsing between the two and six second marks on all three videos. The hook landed and the product never arrived.

> **So every paid asset shows the mat catching scraps inside the first two seconds, and the angle is the scraps and the cleanup rather than the board sliding.**

Worth noting: that $75 result read as a creative failure at the time. Against Appendix A it looks more like the same margin wall.

APPENDIX E OPEN ITEMS

What I need, in order

1. **The mini financial model, with a date on it.** It outranks the campaign, because it decides whether paid is ever viable. The three lines that matter: volume pricing on boards, silicone sourcing on the mat at roughly $26, and the $11 an order going to branding, packaging, shipping, and fees.
2. **Budget confirmation,** $25 a day for four weeks, $700. The floor is $15 a day, $420, which screens the creative but little else.
3. **Three site fixes,** starting with the mat page listing the cutting board's contents and calling itself rubberwood. That is now the page every paid dollar lands on. Also the duplicated section on the same page, and the "restocking soon" banner sitting above in-stock products.
4. **Admin access to Business Manager and the ad account.**
5. **Confirmation that abandoned checkout recovery is switched on.** I could not detect an email tool from outside the site.

Nothing here blocks building the creatives. Items 2 and 4 block launch. Item 1 decides what we do with whatever the launch tells us.